East Ridge, Yepak Plateau, Avalanche Hill, Mor Post, Firm Base, West Ridge and the landing strip on the west bank of the river. Approximately three kilometres to the north of the Maha Plateau is Ashi Hill, south of which flows the Namti River.

Further to the north on the frontier, northwest of Kibithu is Glei-la (12,820 feet). Across the boundary in Tibet is Sama while a kilometre to the south of Kibithu is the drop zone. On the east bank of the Lohit is the Sangam dominated by the Hump, while to its east is the Dichu Ridge. About half a mile to the north of the Dichu Ridge is the McMahon Ridge, the dominating feature of which is Dome. Along the Kahoo axis up the Di Chu valley, beyond the Hot Springs, was the Jachap post manned by the Assam Rifles.

THE FIGHTING AT KIBITHU

The Chinese had first intruded into the Lohit Frontier Division in October 1957 when troops had come downriver all the way to Walong. On being challenged, the party returned to Tibet. On 28 September 1958, an officer with fifty soldiers advanced into the Di Chu Valley up to Jachap. Subsequently, they continued to send small probing parties into the area, culminating with the official note handed over by the government of the People's Republic of China stating that: 'Monyul, the area of Lower Tsayul including Walong, not only was inhabited by Tibetans, but was always under the jurisdiction of Tibet. British troops unlawfully invaded and occupied Walong in 1944, and it was only after the local Tibet government sent a representative of the dzongpen of Sangacho Dzong to make representations that the troops withdrew.'

This was typical Chinese misinformation. First, the entire belt, though sparsely populated, was the home of the Miji Mishmi with perhaps a scattering of Tibetans, if at all. Second, unlike the Tawang region where the writ of the Tibetan dzongpen carried weight, in the Lohit Frontier Division it had no influence. These incursions, therefore, had prompted Army HQ to move 2 Rajput into Walong to support the single Assam Rifles wing at Kibithu. Even if the Chinese considered Diphu-la to be the tri-junction, as a matter of policy, they did not like to intrude into 'disputed territory'. The intrusions into the Lohit Frontier Division were interpreted as a clear indication that the Chinese would sooner or later try to move troops into the area, just as they had in the Aksai Chin region.